ISSUE
No
XIII

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026
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ISSUE
No
XIII

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

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> No. I can survive well enough on my own— if given the proper reading material.
>
> -SARAH J. MAAS

STAY INFORMED.
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THE HINDU
INDIAN ECONOMY / MACROECONOMICS

Endurance test: On the Indian economy's resilience

> *Strong Q1 growth faces critical headwinds from volatile oil prices, monsoons, and sluggish demand.*

September 2, 2026 · 3 min read
DAILY EDITORIAL READER

India's economic growth during the first quarter of this financial year has surprised most people. Against a **perception**[3] among economists that growth would slow to about 6%-7% **on account of**[4] the impact of the West Asia crisis, real growth in the April-June 2026 quarter came in at a **robust**[5] 7.8%. This was not a statistical **anomaly**[6], either, as growth was **underpinned**[7] by strong performances in both manufacturing and services. In fact, the manufacturing sector grew at a three-quarter-high of 9.2%. The sector has likely benefited from the Goods and Services Tax rate cut implemented last September, and further from the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) 125-basis point **cumulative**[8] interest rate cuts through 2025. A part of it is also that companies likely **front-loaded**[9] their output in the expectation of further uncertainty on inflation, potential future rate hikes, and other possible **headwinds**[10]. The other piece of good news is that capital creation seems to have picked up. While it is not yet clear what the share is between the government and the private sector, capital creation overall has a welcome **multiplier effect**[11] on the economy. The services sector, too, has continued to see **robust**[5] growth, adding strength to the economy. Yet, the economy is not **out of the woods**[12], and this **robust**[5] performance will be more difficult to **replicate**[13] in the quarters ahead. As Chief Economic Adviser V. Anantha Nageswaran has cautioned, Hormuz uncertainty is likely to keep oil prices above $80 a barrel, too high for a country that imports 85%-90% of its oil requirement.

This is perhaps why Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday **reiterated**[14] his appeal to Indians to buy local, avoid non-essential foreign travel and weddings abroad, and stop unnecessary purchases of gold. The pressure of maintaining a reasonable **trade deficit**[15] has so far rested on India's services exports. This has served India reasonably well so far, but the global economy is **stuttering**[16]. This, combined with the growth of Artificial Intelligence services elsewhere, could hurt demand for Indian services exports going ahead. The economy is also yet to face the **full brunt**[17] of a **deficient**[18] monsoon and the impact this will have on rural demand. The consumption-related data for July in the Index of Industrial Production already points to **sluggish**[19] rural demand. While inflation remains well within the RBI's comfort zone, it has been increasing. The RBI expects it to hit 5.9% in October-December 2026, which would further hit demand. The front-loading of manufacturing will also, by definition, **peter out**[20] over the next few quarters. The strength of the Indian economy's **resilience**[2] was tested in Q1 and it passed **admirably**[21]. However, the much tougher **stamina**[22] test remains.

Source: The Hindu
Published: September 02, 2026 12:20 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

1	**Endurance**	(Noun)	Stamina	सहनशक्ति / टिकाऊपन
2	**Resilience**	(Noun)	Flexibility	लचीलापन / पुनः संभलने की क्षमता
3	**Perception**	(Noun)	View	धारणा / दृष्टिकोण
4	**on account of**	(Preposition)	Because of	के कारण / की वजह से
5	**Robust**	(Adjective)	Strong	मजबूत / सशक्त
6	**Anomaly**	(Noun)	Oddity	विसंगति / असामान्य बात
7	**Underpinned**	(Verb)	Supported	आधारित / सुदृढ़ किया हुआ
8	**Cumulative**	(Adjective)	Combined	संचयी / कुल मिलाकर
9	**Front-loaded**	(Verb)	Advanced	शुरुआत में ही केंद्रित करना या अग्रिम कर लेना
10	**Headwinds**	(Noun)	Obstacles	विपरीत परिस्थितियां / बाधाएं
11	**Multiplier effect**	(Noun)	Chain reaction	गुणक प्रभाव
12	**out of the woods**	(Phrase)	Safe	खतरे से बाहर
13	**Replicate**	(Verb)	Duplicate	दोहराना / अनुकरण करना
14	**Reiterated**	(Verb)	Repeated	दोहराया / पुनः पुष्टि की
15	**Trade deficit**	(Noun)	Trade shortfall	व्यापार घाटा
16	**Stuttering**	(Verb)	Faltering	लड़खड़ाती हुई / रुक-रुक कर चलने वाली
17	**full brunt**	(Noun)	Main force	मुख्य आघात / पूरा असर
18	**Deficient**	(Adjective)	Lacking	अपूर्ण / कम / अपर्याप्त
19	**Sluggish**	(Adjective)	Slow	सुस्त / मंद
20	**peter out**	(Verb)	Fade	धीरे-धीरे समाप्त होना / क्षीण होना
21	**Admirably**	(Adverb)	Praiseworthily	सराहनीय ढंग से
22	**Stamina**	(Noun)	Staying power	सहनशक्ति / ऊर्जा

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Endurance test: On the Indian economy's resilience
THE HINDU · INDIAN ECONOMY / MACROECONOMICS

EDITORIAL STANCE
CAUTIOUS
"mindful of upcoming risks"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author examines India's impressive first-quarter GDP growth driven by manufacturing and services while noting the domestic and external challenges ahead. By highlighting risks such as elevated oil prices, a deficient monsoon, and stuttering global exports, the editorial warns that sustaining this economic momentum will require navigating significant macroeconomic headwinds.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 14 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Endurance** NOUN POSITIVE	सहनशक्ति / टिकाऊपन The ability to sustain a prolonged stressful effort or challenging situation without giving way.	Think of 'Endure' + 'ance' — the ability to endure hardships till the very end.	stamina durability resilience	fragility weakness debility
02	**Resilience** NOUN POSITIVE	लचीलापन / पुनः संभलने की क्षमता The capacity to withstand or recover quickly from difficult conditions and shocks.	Sounds like 're-silence' or bouncing back to peace and strength after a disruption.	toughness buoyancy adaptability	vulnerability inflexibility rigidity
03	**Perception** NOUN NEUTRAL	धारणा / दृष्टिकोण A belief or opinion held by people based on how things seem.	Connect with 'perceive' — the way our senses and mind form an impression of reality.	impression notion understanding	misconception ignorance fact
04	**Robust** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	मजबूत / सशक्त Strong, healthy, and vigorous in operation or output.	Sounds like 'robot' — built to be tough, powerful, and durable.	sturdy vigorous resilient	feeble sluggish fragile
05	**Underpinned** VERB POSITIVE	आधारित / सुदृढ़ किया हुआ Supported, justified, or formed the basis of an argument, system, or growth rate.	Pinning a structure from underneath gives it solid support from below.	buttressed bolstered reinforced	undermined weakened destabilised
06	**Cumulative** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	संचयी / कुल मिलाकर Increasing or growing by successive additions over a period.	Relate to 'accumulate' — growing by successive additions over time.	aggregate collective accrued	individual discrete isolated
07	**Headwinds** NOUN NEGATIVE	विपरीत परिस्थितियां / बाधाएं Conditions or factors that restrict, delay, or slow down progress and growth.	Winds blowing directly against your 'head', slowing down your forward motion.	impediments hindrances deterrents	tailwinds catalysts boosters
08	**Replicate** VERB NEUTRAL	दोहराना / अनुकरण करना To reproduce, repeat, or perform an action again in the exact same manner.	Sounds like 'replica' — creating an exact copy or repeating the same feat.	duplicate reproduce emulate	originate deviate diverge
09	**Reiterated** VERB NEUTRAL	दोहराया / पुनः पुष्टि की Stated or expressed something again, typically for emphasis or clarity.	'Re-iterate' = iterate (state) again with emphasis.	restated reaffirmed repeated	retracted revoked withdrew
10	**Stuttering** VERB NEGATIVE	लड़खड़ाती हुई / रुक-रुक कर चलने वाली Progressing irregularly, unsteadily, or with frequent halts and interruptions.	Just like a stutter interrupts speech fluency, a stuttering economy halts and falters.	faltering stumbling hesitating	surging thriving flourishing
11	**Deficient** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अपूर्ण / कम / अपर्याप्त Not having enough of a specified quality or ingredient; insufficient.	Linked to 'deficit' — not possessing enough of what is required.	insufficient inadequate scant	abundant adequate surplus
12	**Sluggish** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	सुस्त / मंद Slow-moving, inactive, or lacking energy and growth.	Slow as a 'slug' that crawls along with minimal pace.	languid inactive torpid	brisk dynamic buoyant
13	**Admirably** ADVERB POSITIVE	सराहनीय ढंग से In a manner that arouses approval or deserves high praise.	Doing something in a way that makes others 'admire' you.	commendably splendidly laudably	poorly disgracefully deplorably
14	**Stamina** NOUN POSITIVE	सहनशक्ति / ऊर्जा The ability to sustain prolonged physical or mental effort without tiring.	Athletes need high stamina to stand and run throughout a marathon.	staying power grit vitality	lethargy exhaustion feebleness

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · ENDURANCE TEST: ON THE INDIAN ECONOMY'S RESILIENCE

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Anomaly** NOUN NEUTRAL	विसंगति / असामान्य बात Something that deviates from what is standard, normal, or expected.	'A-normal-y' — something that deviates from what is normal or standard.	aberration irregularity deviation	normality conformity regularity
02	**Multiplier effect** NOUN POSITIVE	गुणक प्रभाव An economic effect where an initial injection of spending produces a proportionately larger increase in overall economic activity.	Think of multiplying: one initial investment multiplies output across several sectors.	ripple effect spillover effect cumulative effect	diminishing return dilution drain
03	**Trade deficit** NOUN NEGATIVE	व्यापार घाटा The amount by which the cost of a country's imports exceeds the value of its exports.	A 'deficit' in trade means money flowing out on imports exceeds money coming in from exports.	negative trade balance trade gap import surplus	trade surplus positive trade balance export surplus

PHRASAL VERBS · 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Front-loaded** VERB NEUTRAL	शुरुआत में ही केंद्रित करना या अग्रिम कर लेना Distributed or concentrated resources, output, or costs primarily at the beginning of a period.	Loading all your cargo in the 'front' portion before moving ahead.	preloaded advanced preponed	deferred postponed back-loaded
02	**peter out** VERB NEGATIVE	धीरे-धीरे समाप्त होना / क्षीण होना To gradually become smaller or weaker before stopping completely.	Think of a stream getting smaller and smaller until it peters out entirely.	dwindle taper off wane	escalate intensify swell

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**on account of** PREPOSITION NEUTRAL	के कारण / की वजह से Owing to or by reason of a specified factor.	Think of an 'account' explaining the reason or financial ledger for an event.	owing to due to by virtue of	regardless of despite in spite of
02	**out of the woods** PHRASE POSITIVE	खतरे से बाहर No longer in danger, difficulty, or jeopardy.	Stepping out of a dark, dangerous forest into open safety.	out of danger clear of risk in the clear	in jeopardy at risk vulnerable
03	**full brunt** NOUN NEGATIVE	मुख्य आघात / पूरा असर The worst part or principal force of a shock, blow, or difficult circumstance.	Brunt sounds like 'blunt impact' — facing the absolute heaviest blow.	full force major impact heaviest burden	cushion mitigation protection

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Do not gamble: On the Russia-Ukraine conflict →

THE HINDU
GEOPOLITICS / INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Do not gamble: On the Russia-Ukraine conflict

> *Escalation risks a wider NATO war, requiring immediate diplomatic engagement to resolve the crisis.*

September 2, 2026 · 2 min read
DAILY EDITORIAL READER

With Russia and Ukraine **escalating**[1] their long-range attacks on each other's territory, the risk of the conflict **spilling over into**[2] other parts of Europe is rising. There have been isolated but significant incidents suggesting that Russia is carrying out '**gray zone**[3]' attacks, testing the **resolve**[4] of the North Atlantic Treaty Organisation (NATO). Three explosive drones were discovered near a German airport. One was shot down over Romania, while another Russian **projectile**[5] landed in Poland. European officials also say that Russia is recruiting foreign agents for **sabotage**[6] and conducting cyberattacks for digital **espionage**[7]. According to U.S. media reports, U.S. intelligence agencies believe that Russian President Vladimir Putin, **under pressure**[18] at home amid Ukraine's growing long-range attacks, could carry out a cyberattack or a limited land **incursion**[8] into NATO territory in the years ahead. CIA chief John Ratcliffe visited Moscow **in a bid to**[9] warn the Kremlin against **escalating**[1] the war into NATO member-states. Inside Russia, government officials and nationalist voices have **hardened**[10] their **rhetoric**[11]. A Foreign Ministry spokesperson recently said British military facilities "located both inside Ukraine and beyond its borders" may become legitimate targets if Ukraine continues to attack Russia with British weapons. Mikhail Galuzin, Russia's Deputy Foreign Minister, recently threatened to **topple**[12] the regime in Kyiv and establish a new governance body — all suggesting that Russia could be preparing to escalate the war.

Russia still has no clear path to victory. Yes, Russia has taken more than 20% of Ukraine's pre-2014 territory. But its **incremental**[13] territorial gains have slowed. Until early this year, the Russians were using artillery, glide bombs, drones and infantry to blast through Ukraine's deeply **entrenched**[14] positions. But with its long-range attacks, particularly on Russia's energy sector, supply networks, and military systems, Ukraine's new aerial front is **inflicting**[15] economic pain on the Russians. According to some reports, Ukrainian attacks have knocked out roughly 20% of Russia's refining capacity. Russia is also striking Ukraine — its air defences are weak — with drones and ballistic missiles. But with continuing support from Europe, Kyiv has managed to **withstand**[16] Russia's hits. But this **stalemate**[17] is dangerous. **Under pressure**[18] at home and stuck on the frontline, Russia could use U.S. **preoccupation**[19] in the Persian Gulf to escalate the conflict and break the **impasse**[20]. But that would be a huge mistake, as it could trigger an **all-out**[21] war between two nuclear-armed sides. Escalation would only **compound**[22] Russia's problems. Mr. Putin should instead **opt for**[23] serious diplomatic engagement with Ukraine and the West, to find a **middle ground**[24] and end Europe's longest war since the Second World War.

Source: The Hindu
Published: September 02, 2026 12:10 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

1	**Escalating**	(Verb)	Increasing	बढ़ाना / तीव्र करना
2	**Spilling over into**	(Prepositional phrase)	Spreading to	दूसरे क्षेत्रों में फैलना
3	**Gray zone**	(Noun phrase)	Unclear area	अस्पष्ट स्थिति
4	**Resolve**	(Noun)	Determination	दृढ़ संकल्प
5	**Projectile**	(Noun)	Missile	प्रक्षेप्य / अस्त्र
6	**Sabotage**	(Noun)	Destruction	तोड़-फोड़ / क्षति पहुँचाना
7	**Espionage**	(Noun)	Spying	जासूसी
8	**Incursion**	(Noun)	Raid	घुसपैठ / आक्रमण
9	**In a bid to**	(Prepositional phrase)	In an attempt to	के प्रयास में
10	**Hardened**	(Verb)	Toughened	कड़ा करना / सख्त करना
11	**Rhetoric**	(Noun)	Persuasive speech	बयानबाजी / वाक्पटुता
12	**Topple**	(Verb)	Overthrow	तख्तापलट करना / गिराना
13	**Incremental**	(Adjective)	Gradual	क्रमिक / धीरे-धीरे बढ़ने वाला
14	**Entrenched**	(Adjective)	Firmly fixed	मजबूती से जमा हुआ
15	**Inflicting**	(Verb)	Causing pain	क्षति या कष्ट पहुँचाना
16	**Withstand**	(Verb)	Resist	सामना करना / टिके रहना
17	**Stalemate**	(Noun)	Deadlock	गतिरोध
18	**Under pressure**	(Prepositional phrase)	Stressed	दबाव में
19	**Preoccupation**	(Noun)	Distraction	व्यस्तता / ध्यानमग्नता
20	**Impasse**	(Noun)	Dead end	गतिरोध / बंद रास्ता
21	**All-out**	(Adjective)	Total	पूर्ण / सर्वव्यापी
22	**Compound**	(Verb)	Worsen	बढ़ाना / जटिल बनाना
23	**Opt for**	(Phrasal verb)	Choose	चुनना / विकल्प चुनना
24	**Middle ground**	(Noun phrase)	Compromise	मध्य मार्ग / समझौता

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Do not gamble: On the Russia-Ukraine conflict
THE HINDU · GEOPOLITICS / INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

EDITORIAL STANCE
CAUTIONARY
"warning of dangerous escalation"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author adopts a cautionary tone to highlight the grave risks of expanding the conflict beyond Ukraine's borders into NATO territories. By referencing covert attacks, hardening rhetoric, and ongoing front-line stalemates, the commentary warns against reckless military moves. Ultimately, the editorial advocates for immediate diplomatic engagement over nuclear-risking escalation.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 13 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Escalating** VERB NEGATIVE	बढ़ाना / तीव्र करना Intensifying or increasing rapidly in magnitude or extent.	An escalator moves UP; escalating means taking conflict UP.	intensifying heightening amplifying	de-escalating diminishing reducing
02	**Projectile** NOUN NEUTRAL	प्रक्षेप्य / अस्त्र An object propelled or fired through the air by force.	Project + tile: an object projected or launched into the air.	missile rocket shell	target receiver catcher
03	**Incursion** NOUN NEGATIVE	घुसपैठ / आक्रमण A sudden or brief invasion or attack into foreign territory.	In + current: running swiftly into someone else's territory.	invasion intrusion raid	retreat withdrawal evacuation
04	**Hardened** VERB NEGATIVE	कड़ा करना / सख्त करना Made more unyielding, aggressive, or firm in attitude.	Becoming hard like concrete; unyielding and firm in position.	toughened stiffened entrenched	softened relented weakened
05	**Rhetoric** NOUN NEUTRAL	बयानबाजी / वाक्पटुता Persuasive or aggressive language, often lacking sincere substance.	Rhetoric sounds like 'orator'—forceful speech used to sway people.	oratory declamation discourse	quietude silence conciseness
06	**Topple** VERB NEGATIVE	तख्तापलट करना / गिराना Overthrow or remove a government or authority from power.	Top-heavy structures tumble and topple over.	overthrow unseat oust	inststate establish uphold
07	**Incremental** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	क्रमिक / धीरे-धीरे बढ़ने वाला Relating to or denoting small, step-by-step additions or gains.	Income increasing step-by-step is an incremental change.	gradual step-by-step piecemeal	sudden abrupt rapid
08	**Entrenched** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	मजबूती से जमा हुआ Firmly established and difficult to alter or dislodge.	Dug deep inside a trench, making removal nearly impossible.	ingrained established deep-rooted	transient precarious unsettled
09	**Inflicting** VERB NEGATIVE	क्षति या कष्ट पहुँचाना Causing something painful or unpleasant to be suffered.	Conflict inflicts pain on innocent people.	imposing wreaking delivering	alleviating relieving soothing
10	**Withstand** VERB POSITIVE	सामना करना / टिके रहना Offer strong resistance to or remain undamaged by external force.	Standing firm against strong winds without falling.	endure resist weather	succumb yield surrender
11	**Preoccupation** NOUN NEUTRAL	व्यस्तता / ध्यानमग्नता The state of being engrossed in or distracted by a specific concern.	Occupied completely beforehand with another pressing thought.	absorption engrossment distraction	inattention indifference unconcern
12	**All-out** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	पूर्ण / सर्वव्यापी Using all available energy, power, and resources; complete.	Putting all resources out onto the field with maximum force.	total unlimited comprehensive	partial limited restrained
13	**Compound** VERB NEGATIVE	बढ़ाना / जटिल बनाना Make a bad situation worse or intensify a negative state.	Compound interest adds up fast; compounding errors makes a bad situation worse.	aggravate worsen exacerbate	mitigate ease alleviate

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · DO NOT GAMBLE: ON THE RUSSIA-UKRAINE CONFLICT

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 4 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Resolve** NOUN POSITIVE	दृढ़ संकल्प Firm determination or willingness to adhere to a course of action.	To 're-solve' a tough problem until success demands strong determination.	firmness resolution fortitude	indecision hesitation vacillation
02	**Sabotage** NOUN NEGATIVE	तोड़-फोड़ / क्षति पहुँचाना Deliberate destruction or damage performed to weaken an enemy or rival.	Throwing wooden shoes (sabots) into machinery to intentionally damage it.	subversion vandalism disruption	protection restoration assistance
03	**Espionage** NOUN NEGATIVE	जासूसी The practice of spying to obtain secret political or military information.	Agent 'Spy-on-age': espionage is the act of covert spying.	spying reconnaissance intelligence-gathering	transparency candour openness
04	**Stalemate** NOUN NEGATIVE	गतिरोध A state where further progress by opposing sides seems impossible.	A stale position in chess where no player can make a legal move.	deadlock impasse standstill	breakthrough resolution progress

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Spilling over into** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE NEGATIVE	दूसरे क्षेत्रों में फैलना Uncontrollably reaching or affecting adjacent areas or subjects.	Imagine liquid spilling over the rim of a glass onto the adjacent table.	overflowing into extending to spreading into	staying contained remaining within receding from

PHRASAL VERBS · 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Opt for** PHRASAL VERB NEUTRAL	चुनना / विकल्प चुनना To make a choice from a range of possibilities.	Selecting a specific option from available choices.	choose select decide on	reject decline discard

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 4 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Gray zone** NOUN PHRASE NEGATIVE	अस्पष्ट स्थिति An ambiguous state between peace and open war involving covert or unattributable actions.	Between black (war) and white (peace) lies the unclear gray zone.	ambiguous space shadowy realm unclear boundary	clear distinction black-and-white state explicit territory
02	**In a bid to** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE NEUTRAL	के प्रयास में With the intention or aim of attempting to achieve something.	Making a bid at an auction to attempt to win an item.	attempting to in an effort to seeking to	refraining from avoiding to neglecting to
03	**Under pressure** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE NEGATIVE	दबाव में Facing intense stress, strain, or urgency from surrounding factors.	Feeling squashed under heavy weight or high expectations.	strained stressed burdened	at ease relaxed unburdened
04	**Middle ground** NOUN PHRASE POSITIVE	मध्य मार्ग / समझौता An area of compromise or agreement between opposing viewpoints.	Standing on neutral territory between two opposing sides.	compromise golden mean concession	extremism polarisation intransigence

FOREIGN WORDS · 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Impasse** NOUN NEGATIVE	गतिरोध / बंद रास्ता A situation in which no progress is possible, especially because of disagreement.	French origin: an 'impossible pass' where no path forward exists.	deadlock stalemate gridlock	advance solution continuation

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
Delhi to Bishkek: Overcoming limits →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS
GEOPOLITICS & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Delhi to Bishkek: Overcoming limits

> *India must overcome regional geographical barriers by deepening bilateral ties and non-physical connectivity.*

September 2, 2026 · 2 min read
DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's address at the 26th summit of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, comes at a time when Central Asia is **diversifying**[1] its partnerships in all directions. A region long shaped by its Soviet past and one that still maintains economic links with Russia, its five countries are now also looking to China for trade, investment and infrastructure, and to Iran and the Gulf for access to the south, though the ongoing conflict **complicates**[2] the latter. The region's growing **strategic**[3] importance and shared security concerns, including terrorism, have led India and all Central Asian countries except Turkmenistan, which maintains permanent **neutrality**[4], to establish **strategic**[3] partnerships. This **evolving**[5] context makes the PM's visit even more significant.

The PM's speech focused mainly on two issues: Connectivity and terrorism. The absence of direct land access has **constrained**[6] trade and wider economic and cultural engagement. There is no overland access through Pakistan, and Afghanistan's airspace remains **beset by**[7] security risks. But connectivity goes far beyond building roads and railways. At its core, it is about shaping the economic and **strategic**[3] geography of Eurasia. India, therefore, must find ways to expand economic engagement while overcoming the **limitations**[8] **imposed by**[9] geography. A starting point could be to focus on products and services that do not depend on roads — services, digital systems and technological investments. On terrorism, the prime minister is right to **call on**[10] the international community to collectively **dismantle**[11] the **ecosystem**[12] of terror, including its financing and **recruitment**[13] networks. The reality New Delhi must recognise, however, is that the international political will against terrorism has weakened. Over the past year, Pakistan has largely overcome its diplomatic **isolation**[14], and it is set to **assume**[15] the organisation's **rotational**[16] chairmanship. In June last year, SCO defence ministers could not agree on the references to terrorism in their joint statement. China **possesses**[17] greater financial resources than any other member and is heavily investing in Central Asian infrastructure as part of the Belt and Road Initiative. Delhi should therefore **place greater weight on**[18] its individual partnerships with member states.

The agreement with Uzbekistan on the long-term supply of uranium is a **step in that direction**[19]. Central Asian countries are emerging as **multi-vector**[20] actors. Rather than choosing between **competing**[21] powers, they are seeking multiple options to improve access to market. India should become one of those options — and use a **multilateral**[22] forum like the SCO to advance **bilateral**[23] relationships. That is a strategy New Delhi should **carry forward**[24] to BRICS, as it prepares to host its 18th summit.

Source: The Indian Express
Published: September 02, 2026 06:00 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

1	**Diversifying**	(Verb)	Varying	विविधता लाना
2	**Complicates**	(Verb)	Confuses	जटिल बनाना
3	**Strategic**	(Adjective)	Calculated	रणनीतिक
4	**Neutrality**	(Noun)	Impartiality	तटस्थता
5	**Evolving**	(Adjective)	Developing	विकसित हो रहा
6	**Constrained**	(Verb)	Restricted	बाधित किया
7	**Beset by**	(Verb)	Troubled by	से घिरा हुआ / ग्रस्त
8	**Limitations**	(Noun)	Restrictions	सीमाएं / बाधाएं
9	**Imposed by**	(Verb)	Enforced by	द्वारा थोपा गया
10	**Call on**	(Verb)	Appeal to	आह्वान करना
11	**Dismantle**	(Verb)	Deconstruct	ध्वस्त करना / विघटित करना
12	**Ecosystem**	(Noun)	Network	पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र / जटिल तंत्र
13	**Recruitment**	(Noun)	Enlistment	भर्ती
14	**Isolation**	(Noun)	Separation	अलगाव
15	**Assume**	(Verb)	Take on	पदभार ग्रहण करना
16	**Rotational**	(Adjective)	Alternating	आवर्ती / चक्रीय
17	**Possesses**	(Verb)	Holds	अधिकार में होना
18	**Place greater weight on**	(Phrase)	Prioritise	अधिक महत्व देना
19	**Step in that direction**	(Phrase)	Progress	उस दिशा में बढ़ाया गया कदम
20	**Multi-vector**	(Adjective)	Multi-directional	बहु-आयामी (विदेश नीति)
21	**Competing**	(Adjective)	Rival	प्रतिस्पर्धी
22	**Multilateral**	(Adjective)	Multi-party	बहुपक्षीय
23	**Bilateral**	(Adjective)	Two-way	द्विपक्षीय
24	**Carry forward**	(Verb)	Advance	आगे ले जाना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Delhi to Bishkek: Overcoming limits
THE INDIAN EXPRESS · GEOPOLITICS & INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

EDITORIAL STANCE
PRAGMATIC / ANALYTICAL
"practical and strategic analysis"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author evaluates India's strategic imperatives in Central Asia amidst connectivity hurdles and shifting multilateral alignments within the SCO. Rather than relying solely on fractured multilateral frameworks, the piece advises New Delhi to pursue bilateral economic cooperation and digital linkages. It underscores the necessity of adapting foreign policy to the multi-aligned realities of the Eurasian region.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 15 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Diversifying** VERB POSITIVE	विविधता लाना Expanding into a wider range of different areas, partnerships, or fields.	Think of 'diverse' — expanding in various directions rather than staying in one place.	variegating expanding broadening	concentrating limiting narrowing
02	**Complicates** VERB NEGATIVE	जटिल बनाना Makes something much more difficult, confusing, or intricate to deal with.	Sounds like 'complex' — making a smooth situation complex and problematic.	entangling confounding hindering	simplifying facilitating clarifying
03	**Strategic** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	रणनीतिक Carefully designed or chosen to serve a long-term vital goal or interest.	Linked to 'strategy' — planned deliberately to gain an advantage.	tactical deliberate judicious	unplanned random arbitrary
04	**Evolving** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	विकसित हो रहा Gradually changing, developing, and adapting over time.	Think of 'evolution' — continuous, gradual adaptation and transformation.	unfolding advancing maturing	stagnating regressing deteriorating
05	**Constrained** VERB NEGATIVE	बाधित किया Severely restricted, hindered, or limited in scope or movement.	Sound like 'constricted' — tightened or held back from expanding freely.	curbed impeded inhibited	liberated expanded facilitated
06	**Limitations** NOUN NEGATIVE	सीमाएं / बाधाएं Rules, boundaries, or physical conditions that restrict capabilities.	From 'limit' — boundaries that prevent further movement or growth.	constraints impediments shortcomings	possibilities freedoms advantages
07	**Dismantle** VERB NEGATIVE	ध्वस्त करना / विघटित करना To systematically take apart or destroy an organisation, machine, or structure.	Dis + Mantle (cover/structure) — tearing down the protective framework.	demolish deconstruct disband	assemble construct establish
08	**Ecosystem** NOUN NEUTRAL	पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र / जटिल तंत्र A complex, interconnected network of supporting elements or institutions.	Eco + System — a complete, interconnected environment that sustains an activity.	structure framework milieu	isolation disorganisation disconnection
09	**Recruitment** NOUN NEUTRAL	भर्ती The process of enlisting, attracting, or mobilising new members into an organisation.	Re-crew — signing up new members for a crew or organisation.	enrolment induction mobilisation	discharge expulsion dismissal
10	**Isolation** NOUN NEGATIVE	अलगाव The condition of being cut off or alienated diplomatically, socially, or physically.	Think of an 'island' (isle) — cut off and distanced from everyone else.	seclusion ostracism alienation	integration inclusion engagement
11	**Assume** VERB NEUTRAL	पदभार ग्रहण करना To formally take on, acquire, or enter upon a role, responsibility, or leadership duty.	Assume power — accepting and stepping into a designated office.	undertake adopt shoulder	relinquish surrender renounce
12	**Rotational** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	आवर्ती / चक्रीय Occurring in turns or cyclical succession among members.	From 'rotate' — turning or passing from one member to the next in turns.	cyclical sequential recurrent	permanent static fixed
13	**Possesses** VERB NEUTRAL	अधिकार में होना Owns, holds, or has a particular quality, power, or financial capacity.	Possession — having full ownership or command over resources.	commands maintains retains	lacks forfeits yields
14	**Multi-vector** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	बहु-आयामी (विदेश नीति) Balancing foreign relations across multiple independent strategic and diplomatic fronts.	Multi (many) + Vector (directed path) — pursuing multiple foreign policy pathways at once.	multi-directional polycentric diversified	uni-directional polarised monolithic
15	**Competing** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	प्रतिस्पर्धी Striving against one another for superiority, resources, or influence.	From 'competition' — two or more parties striving against each other.	contending rival conflicting	cooperating aligned harmonious

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · DELHI TO BISHKEK: OVERCOMING LIMITS

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Neutrality** NOUN NEUTRAL	तटस्थता The state or policy of not supporting or helping either side in a conflict or competition.	From 'neutral' like a car gear — not moving towards either side.	non-alignment impartiality detachment	partisanship bias favouritism
02	**Multilateral** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	बहुपक्षीय Agreed upon or participated in by three or more international parties or nations.	Multi (many) + Lateral (sides) — involving many sides or countries.	international plurilateral collective	unilateral bilateral isolated
03	**Bilateral** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	द्विपक्षीय Involving or affecting two participating parties, governments, or nations directly.	Bi (two) + Lateral (sides) — directly between two entities.	reciprocal two-sided dual	unilateral multilateral omnilateral

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Beset by** VERB NEGATIVE	से घिरा हुआ / ग्रस्त Plagued, troubled, or threatened persistently on all sides by difficulties or dangers.	Be + Set — Surrounded and attacked from all sides by troubles.	plagued by tormented by besieged by	free of unaffected by relieved of
02	**Imposed by** VERB NEUTRAL	द्वारा थोपा गया Forced upon someone or necessitated by an external condition or authority.	Impose = putting a heavy 'post' or load onto someone by force.	inflicted by levied by dictated by	removed by waived by revoked by

PHRASAL VERBS · 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Call on** VERB NEUTRAL	आह्वान करना To formally make a request or appeal to an individual or group to take action.	Calling out loud to someone to ask for their immediate action.	urge summon entreat	discourage ignore dissuade
02	**Carry forward** VERB POSITIVE	आगे ले जाना To continue development of a strategy, principle, or progress into subsequent stages.	Carrying luggage ahead — transporting an idea or strategy into future venues.	perpetuate maintain propel	abandon halt discontinue

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Place greater weight on** PHRASE POSITIVE	अधिक महत्व देना To attach more importance, significance, or value to a specific factor or strategy.	Adding heavier weights on a scale to show its higher priority and value.	emphasise accentuate highlight	undervalue downplay disregard
02	**Step in that direction** PHRASE POSITIVE	उस दिशा में बढ़ाया गया कदम An action or measure that contributes positively toward reaching a defined goal.	Taking a literal physical stride toward an ultimate destination.	stride forward positive move advancement	setback retrograde move regression

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
On packaged foods in India, now a red label, and a long overdue warning →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS
PUBLIC HEALTH

On packaged foods in India, now a red label, and a long overdue warning

> *Mandatory front-of-pack red warning labels mark a crucial first step against India's surging obesity crisis.*

September 2, 2026 · 2 min read
DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Amid[1] rapidly expanding concerns about Indians' growing consumption of food high in sugar, **refined**[2] carbohydrates, salt and unhealthy fats comes the FSSAI proposal to implement front-of-pack warnings in the form of red, hexagonal labels on packaged food. Sweetened beverages will carry a separate warning. The proposal comes weeks after the Supreme Court **pulled up**[3] the **apex**[4] food regulator for failing to move on warning labels. It is a welcome step towards addressing **alarming**[5] levels of **obesity**[6], particularly among children — India now ranks second globally, after China, for the number of children who are overweight or living with **obesity**[6].

Given that eating behaviour is complex and influenced by a number of factors, including gender, economic **wherewithal**[7], awareness and faith-based restrictions, there has been **scepticism**[8] about the effectiveness of food warnings. But there is also evidence that such **interventions**[9] can change consumption patterns. For example, Chile witnessed a 24 per cent drop in sugary drink consumption after it introduced black octagonal warning labels on packages in 2016. Clarity and **legibility**[10] are key; a previous FSSAI proposal to use a health star rating system was criticised as such stars are usually **perceived as**[11] positive and warning labels **bearing**[12] them have been **associated with**[13] increased consumption of unhealthy foods.

The notification and timeline for implementation are still awaited. Experts have warned that the two-or-more-unhealthy ingredients **threshold**[14] in the first of the intended two-phase implementation could **leave out**[15] products that are high in just one unhealthy ingredient. There are concerns that the proposed font size may be too small to be effective. Warning labels, finally, can only be one part of a larger approach. Addressing the **obesity**[6] **epidemic**[16] — which exists **alongside**[17] **malnutrition**[18] — will require a broader public-health response that includes raising nutritional awareness, stronger regulation of junk food and **nudges towards**[19] healthier lifestyles. A red label on a packet may not, **by itself**[20], make people eat better, but it is a useful place to start if it makes it easier to **tell** healthy choices **from**[21] harmful ones.

Source: The Indian Express
Published: September 02, 2026 06:05 AM IST

VOCABULARY 101

1	**Amid**	(Preposition)	In the middle of	के बीच में
2	**Refined**	(Adjective)	Processed	परिष्कृत / संसाधित
3	**Pulled up**	(Verb)	Scolded	फटकार लगाना
4	**Apex**	(Adjective)	Topmost	सर्वोच्च
5	**Alarming**	(Adjective)	Worrying	चिंताजनक
6	**Obesity**	(Noun)	Overweight condition	मोटापा
7	**Wherewithal**	(Noun)	Resources / Means	साधन / आवश्यक धन
8	**Scepticism**	(Noun)	Doubt	संदेहवाद
9	**Interventions**	(Noun)	Actions taken	हस्तक्षेप
10	**Legibility**	(Noun)	Readability	सुपाठ्यता
11	**Perceived as**	(Verb)	Seen as	के रूप में माना जाना
12	**Bearing**	(Verb)	Carrying / Showing	धारण किए हुए
13	**Associated with**	(Adjective)	Linked to	से जुड़ा हुआ
14	**Threshold**	(Noun)	Cut-off limit	सीमा / दहलीज़
15	**Leave out**	(Verb)	Exclude	छोड़ देना / बाहर रखना
16	**Epidemic**	(Noun)	Widespread outbreak	महामारी
17	**Alongside**	(Preposition)	Together with	के साथ-साथ
18	**Malnutrition**	(Noun)	Poor nutrition	कुपोषण
19	**Nudges towards**	(Verb)	Gently encourages	की ओर धीरे से प्रेरित करना
20	**By itself**	(Adverb)	Alone	अपने आप में / अकेले
21	**Tell from**	(Verb)	Distinguish between	में भेद पहचानना

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: On packaged foods in India, now a red label, and a long overdue warning
THE INDIAN EXPRESS · PUBLIC HEALTH

EDITORIAL STANCE
CAUTIOUS
"approving yet mindful of limitations"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author commends the regulator's overdue initiative to enforce front-of-pack red warning labels to counter rampant childhood obesity. However, the analysis highlights potential pitfalls such as narrow ingredient thresholds and small font sizes that could dilute consumer impact. Ultimately, the editorial advocates for a comprehensive public-health strategy that pairs clear labelling with nutritional literacy and regulatory reform.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY · 9 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Amid** PREPOSITION NEUTRAL	के बीच में In the middle of or surrounded by events, circumstances, or surroundings.	Think of 'a-mid' as being in the middle of ongoing events.	surrounded by amongst during	away from outside beyond
02	**Refined** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	परिष्कृत / संसाधित Purified or processed by industrial treatment to remove impurities or coarse elements.	Re-fine means made fine again by removing natural, coarse elements.	processed purified treated	unrefined coarse raw
03	**Apex** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सर्वोच्च Occupying the highest point, level, or position of authority in a hierarchy.	Apex sounds like 'A-peak'—the highest peak of a mountain.	highest supreme paramount	lowest bottom subordinate
04	**Alarming** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	चिंताजनक Causing great fear, distress, or sudden worry due to severity.	Like an alarm clock waking you up suddenly, alarming news triggers immediate panic.	disturbing disquieting frightening	reassuring comforting calming
05	**Scepticism** NOUN NEGATIVE	संदेहवाद An attitude of doubt or a disposition to question accepted claims and efficacy.	A sceptic keeps an optic (eye) open because they doubt what they hear.	incredulity cynicism distrust	credulity conviction trust
06	**Interventions** NOUN NEUTRAL	हस्तक्षेप Deliberate actions or regulatory measures taken to alter a specific condition or outcome.	Inter (between) + vene (come) -> to come between events to change the outcome.	involvements mediations measures	non-involvement passivity abstentions
07	**Bearing** VERB NEUTRAL	धारण किए हुए Displaying, carrying, or exhibiting a specific mark, inscription, or sign.	A badge 'bearing' a logo carries that logo on its surface.	carrying displaying exhibiting	lacking omitting shedding
08	**Threshold** NOUN NEUTRAL	सीमा / दहलीज़ The specific limit, level, or boundary at which a reaction or regulation takes effect.	Crossing the threshold of a doorway means entering a whole new room or level.	boundary cut-off point limit	core middle centre
09	**Alongside** PREPOSITION NEUTRAL	के साथ-साथ Close beside or simultaneously occurring in co-existence with something.	Standing 'along' the 'side' of someone means accompanying them directly.	together with beside in parallel with	apart from without isolated from

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED · ON PACKAGED FOODS IN INDIA, NOW A RED LABEL, AND A LONG OVERDUE WARNING

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS · 5 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Obesity** NOUN NEGATIVE	मोटापा The medical condition of having excessive body fat that impairs overall health.	Obese individuals face high body mass index (BMI) risks.	corpulence fatness overweightness	slenderness underweightness emaciation
02	**Wherewithal** NOUN NEUTRAL	साधन / आवश्यक धन The financial, material, or logistical means needed for a particular purpose.	Ask yourself: 'Where' is the 'with' to buy 'all' these resources? The means/funds!	resources means finances	inability lack destitution
03	**Legibility** NOUN POSITIVE	सुपाठ्यता The quality of being clear, distinct, and easily deciphered when read.	If font is 'legal', it must have good 'legibility' to be easily deciphered.	readability clarity distinctness	illegibility indistinctness obscurity
04	**Epidemic** NOUN NEGATIVE	महामारी A widespread occurrence of an infectious disease or harmful condition in a community.	Epi (upon) + demos (people) -> something spreading rapidly upon the entire populace.	outbreak plague scourge	rarity containment endemicity
05	**Malnutrition** NOUN NEGATIVE	कुपोषण A medical condition resulting from a lack of proper nutrients or insufficient food intake.	Mal (bad) + Nutrition (food intake) = deficient or unbalanced diet.	undernourishment malnourishment dietary deficiency	nourishment healthiness wholesomeness

FIXED PREPOSITIONS · 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Perceived as** VERB NEUTRAL	के रूप में माना जाना Regarded, interpreted, or viewed in a particular manner by observers.	To perceive + 'as' always describes how something is regarded by the senses.	regarded as viewed as considered to be	misconstrued as overlooked as ignored
02	**Associated with** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	से जुड़ा हुआ Connected with something else in thought, cause, correlation, or function.	An 'associate' works 'with' someone; things that are linked go together.	linked with related to correlated with	unconnected with unrelated to detached from
03	**Nudges towards** VERB POSITIVE	की ओर धीरे से प्रेरित करना Gently and subtly encourages or guides someone towards a specific decision or behaviour.	A gentle physical 'nudge' with an elbow moves someone 'towards' taking action.	prompts towards coaxes towards steers towards	deters from dissuades from discourages from

PHRASAL VERBS · 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Pulled up** VERB NEGATIVE	फटकार लगाना Severely reprimanded, rebuked, or held accountable for an omission or fault.	When a teacher 'pulls you up' to stand before the class, you are being reprimanded.	reprimanded rebuked admonished	praised commended applauded
02	**Leave out** VERB NEGATIVE	छोड़ देना / बाहर रखना To fail to include, intentionally ignore, or omit someone or something.	Leaving someone 'out' of the house means excluding them entirely.	omit exclude bypass	include incorporate encompass
03	**Tell from** VERB NEUTRAL	में भेद पहचानना To recognise or discern the difference between two contrasting things.	Being able to 'tell' one thing 'from' another means your mind can spot the difference.	distinguish from differentiate from discriminate from	confuse with conflate with mix up with

IDIOMS & PHRASES · 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**By itself** ADVERB NEUTRAL	अपने आप में / अकेले Without assistance or extraneous factors; considered purely in isolation.	Acting 'by itself' means functioning in isolation without any external help.	on its own independently in isolation	jointly collaboratively together

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TODAY'S EDITORIALS
ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY

SEPTEMBER 2, 2026

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